

Final Project: Develop your Cybersecurity Career Plan

Estimated time needed: 14 minutes

Overview

During this course, you have become familiar with various roles in Cybersecurity, as well as the skills, qualifications, and certifications required for the different roles. In this project, you will explore real Cybersecurity job postings, analyze them, and develop a plan to become job-ready.

Instructions

Task 1: Identify a cybersecurity role and find a job listing

[A] First, identify a Cybersecurity job role (for example, Cybersecurity Specialist, Cybersecurity Analyst, Cybersecurity Engineer, and so on) that you want to pursue as a career. It may be a role you want to start your Cybersecurity career with or a role that you may aspire to take up at some future point in your career journey.

[B] Next, search for job postings related to the identified Cybersecurity role that you find appealing by going to a job board of your choice (for example, LinkedIn, Indeed, Zip Recruiter, Glassdoor, Monster, Naukri, USAjobs.gov, jobbank.gc.ca, and so on). You could filter or narrow down the job listings based on criteria like the location(s) you are interested in working, employment type (for example, full-time, part-time, freelance, consulting, and so on), industry (for example, Banking, Healthcare, IT, retail, and so on) or other factors. Identify one job listing that interests you, and you can see yourself applying when you have the right skills and qualifications.

Task 2: Understand job details and requirements

Review the identified job listing and understand the job details (title, company, location, responsibilities, employment type, salary range, benefits, and so on) and requirements (skills, educational qualifications, experience, certifications, and so on).

Task 3: Determine job attractiveness

Identify aspects of the job posting that you find suitable and those you don't find appropriate. Are you still interested in applying for a job like this in the future? If not, repeat tasks 1-3 above until you find a Cybersecurity job you would like to do.

Task 4: Identify gaps in your portfolio

Perform a self-assessment and create an inventory of your current portfolio (skills, education, experience, certifications, and so on). Compare this with the job requirements and identify the gaps in your portfolio that you need to bridge to be eligible for the selected Cybersecurity job. For example, what skills and experience do you need to develop, and what educational qualifications and industry certifications do you need to achieve to become job-ready?

Task 5: Create a plan

Based on the gaps in your portfolio (identified in Task 4) versus the requirements listed in the job listing, create a roadmap of actions you need (or a list of steps) to become eligible for the chosen Cybersecurity job. For example, how will you develop the required skills and prepare for any required certifications?

Evaluation

While this project is not graded and does not impact obtaining the course certificate, in the next course item, you can submit certain aspects of your job exploration and career plan development that you completed in the tasks above and receive feedback from an AI-powered evaluator.

You will be asked to respond to the following questions and scored accordingly (60% is the minimum passing score):

1. (1 point) Provide the URL for your selected Job listing for a Cybersecurity role that you can see yourself applying for in the future.
2. (2 points) Provide the following details from the selected Cybersecurity job posting: Company Name, Job Title, Job Location.
3. (2 points) Provide at least 3 IT or cybersecurity skills required for the selected Cybersecurity job listing.
4. (2 points) Provide the following details from the selected Cybersecurity job listing: Education, Preferred Certifications, Experience/background.
5. (2 points) Based on your current education, experience, skills, and certifications, provide a list of steps you will need to be eligible to apply for the chosen Cybersecurity job listing. List the steps required using the following categories: Education/Experience, Skills, and Certifications.